सत्यमेव जयते

DIRECTORATE GENERAL OF CIVIL AVIATION
OPP. SAFDURJUNG AIRPORT, AUROBINDO MARG
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MEDICAL DIRECTORATE

PROCEDURE
FOR
CLASS 3 MEDICAL ASSESSMENT
FOR
AIR TRAFFIC CONTROLLER OFFICERS (ATCOs)

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RECORD OF AMENDMENTS

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PROCEDURE FOR CLASS 3 MEDICAL ASSESSMENT FOR AIR TRAFFIC CONTROLLER OFFICERS (ATCOs)

1. An applicant for grant/renewal of a Student Air Traffic Controller's licence or Air Traffic Controller's licence/rating shall hold a valid Class 3 Medical Assessment issued in accordance with the Civil Aviation Requirement CAR Section 7 Series C Part I Issue II dated 12 Oct 17 on 'Medical Requirements and Examination for Flight Crew/Air Traffic Controllers Licences and Ratings' (Revised on 05 Apr 21).

2. No ATCO shall exercise the privileges of his/her licence/ rating, unless he/she holds a valid Class 3 Medical Assessment.

3. It is therefore important to ensure that ATCOs are examined periodically and if any disability/disease occurs or is detected, a suitable aeromedical decision is taken for the fitness to perform their job.

4. The medical examination shall be carried out as per relevant DGCA procedures and ICAO guidelines on the subject.

5. An Air Traffic Controller, for a Medical Assessment, shall undergo a medical examination based on the following requirements (as per Para 6.5 of Chapter 6 of Annex 1- Personnel Licensing): -

(a) Physical and Mental Requirements
(b) Visual and Colour Perception
(c) Hearing Requirements

6. Class 3 Medical Assessment shall be valid from the date of medical examination for a period, not greater than: -

(a) 04 (four) years – For age up to 40 years
(b) 02 (two) years – For age above 40 years but up to 50 years
(c) 01 (one) year – For age above 50 years

(However, the remainder period of validity after the licence/rating holder attains the age of 40 years or 50 years shall be reduced to half)

Initial Medical Examinations

7. Initial Class 3 medical examination shall be carried out by **DGCA empanelled Class 1 medical examiners only**.

8. ATSTO/ATS-in-charge(s) shall seek appointment with the nearest available DGCA empanelled Class 1 Medical Examiner for medical examination. Applicants shall undergo medical investigations (as specified in Appendix 'A' to this procedure) within a period of 30 days from the examination date. On the date of appointment, the ATCO shall report to the Class 1 Medical Examiner with his/her identity proof and a recent passport size photograph (with name and date annotated on the front). The medical examination shall be conducted on GoI Form CA 34 (Re-revised). On completion of the medical examination, the medical examiner will hand over a copy of CA 35 ('Medical Certificate') to the applicant ATCO. The medical examiner will forward the signed medical reports (completed Form CA 34 & CA 35 along with all original investigation reports and opinions), by registered post/speed-post/courier, to Gp Capt Medical Service (Civil Aviation), at DGCA for approval and issuance of 'Medical Assessment', at the following address: -

Kind Attn: Gp Capt Medical Service (CA), Medical Directorate,
Directorate General of Civil Aviation, Headquarters
Opposite Safdarjung Airport, Aurobindo Marg
New Delhi – 110 003

"The following should be annotated on top of envelop and CA 34 'Class 3 Medical Examination Report".

Renewal Medical Examinations

9. All applicants for Class 3 medical examination shall undergo medical investigations for the Renewal Medical Examination (as per their age) as specified in Appendix 'A'.

10. Renewal of Class 3 medical examination will be carried out by DGCA empanelled Class 3 medical examiners. List of medical examiners is available on DGCA website at https://www.dgca.gov.in/digigov-portal/?page=jsp/dgca/inventory list/personal/medical/class3/class%203%20medical%20examiners.pdf

11. Only the GoI Medical Examination Forms (CA 34/34A and CA 35) to be used by the DGCA empanelled Medical Examiners and these forms are to be filled by 'hand' only. After completion of medical examination, these forms shall be submitted by the Medical Examiner to DGCA for approval and issuance of Medical Assessment by the medical assessors at DGCA.

12. Applicants for Class 3 renewal medical examination shall indicate to the medical examiner whether a Medical Assessment has previously been refused, revoked or suspended and, if so, the reason for such refusal, revocation or suspension. They shall submit a copy of their last medical assessment and same shall be annotated at relevant Paras of CA-34 A.

13. While the Medical Assessment issued from DGCA is awaited, the ATCO shall be in possession of 'Medical Certificate' (CA 35) issued by the medical examiner for exercising the privileges of his/ her licence/ratings. However, Post Temporary Unfitness (TU) & Special Medical Examination, the ATCO can exercise the privileges of his/her license/ rating only after issuance of Medical Assessment by the DGCA.

14. The Medical Assessors at DGCA may supersede the aeromedical disposition given by the DGCA empanelled Medical Examiners. And, where necessary, the Medical Assessors at DGCA may declare the licence/rating holder 'Temporary Unfit or 'Permanent Unfit'. In such a scenario, the ATCO shall cease to perform his/her ATC duties immediately on receipt of information from DGCA or AMA, AAI.

15. The period of validity of the medical assessment shall commence from the date following the date of validity of the previous medical assessment, provided that the renewal medical examination has been conducted not earlier than a period of forty five days (45 days) prior to the 'date of expiry' of the validity of previous medical assessment.

16. The final recommendations for ATCO's medical assessment could be any one of the following: -

(a) Medically Fit
(b) Temporary Unfit
(c) Permanently Unfit

17. ATCO shall not exercise the privileges of his/her licence/rating unless declared fit after a fresh medical examination in the event of his/her having suffered from a sickness or injury which: –

(a) Renders him/her incapable of discharging his/her duties for a continuous period of more than 20 days.

(b) Or is likely to cause unfitness or impair his/her efficiency in the discharge of duties.

18. In the above scenario, the licence holder shall immediately notify all the relevant details of the sickness or injury to AMA, AAI.

19. In case of sickness or injury involving unfitness for the work for which ATCO is licensed for a period of less than or equal to 20 days, the AMA, AAI can declare the ATCO medically fit after evaluating the medical documents. However, in certain cases the AMA, depending on the merits of such cases, issue final disposition for fitness after consultation with Med Directorate, DGCA.

20. In case of absence from the duty for medical reasons (due to any surgery or illness) for a continuous period of more than 20 days or when due for review after 'Temporary Unfitness' period is over, the licence/rating holder shall undergo a Special Medical Examination. The procedure for this special medical examination is as under: -

(a) After the licence/rating holder has clinically recovered, he/she will forward all relevant medical documents (by email) to the AMA, AAI.

(b) AMA of AAI and DGCA Medical Directorate shall jointly take a decision on where to conduct the Special Medical Examination; at an IAF Boarding Centre or by DGCA empanelled Examiner.

(c) The concerned licence/rating holder shall be conveyed to report to any IAF Boarding Centre (based on the availability of appointment) or Class 1/Class 3 Medical Examiner for Special Medical Examination. Thereafter, the licence/ rating holder has to apply for permission on the prescribed application format (placed as Appendix 'B') and apply for medical appointment at IAF Boarding Centre on the prescribed format placed at Appendix 'C'.

(d) The special medical examination shall be conducted for the relevant system only (Medical/Surgical/Ophthalmology/ENT) on form CA 34 A /35. The envelope shall be annotated as 'Special Medical Examination for Class 3 Assessment' in bold letters and forwarded to DGCA by the fastest means for issuance of Medical Assessment.

(e) Once the licence/rating holder is accorded an appointment with DGCA empanelled Medical Examiner or at IAF Boarding Centre on prescribed format as per Appendix 'C'. The same shall be intimated to ATS-in-charge. And, once the Special Medical Examination is completed, the date and details of the special medical examination shall be intimated to AMA, AAI for upkeep of records.

(f) Once Medical Assessment is issued by DGCA to the licence/rating holder, a copy of the same shall be submitted to ATS-in-charge by the licence/ rating holder, who shall communicate the same to AMA AAI through e-mail.

Procedure for Medical Assessment during Pregnancy

21. On confirmation of pregnancy, an ATCO, shall not exercise the privileges of her ratings/ licence and inform ATS in-charge. She shall consult the AMA, AAI for her fitness to exercise privileges of her rating/ licence.

22. The ATCO shall submit the medical fitness report from her treating specialist in Obstetrics/Gynaecology and relevant investigation reports to AMA, AAI at the earliest to enable him/her to make the assessment on her medical fitness.

23. In case of 'low-risk' and 'uncomplicated' pregnancy, the fitness assessment shall be limited to the period until the end of the 34th week of gestation.

24. Post-pregnancy, in case of 'normal vaginal delivery', fitness shall be granted by AMA, AAI after reviewing her hospital discharge summary, relevant investigation reports and 'medical certificate' from her treating specialist in Obstetrics/Gynaecology.

25. Under following conditions, the concerned ATCO shall undergo a 'Special Medical Examination' by a DGCA empaneled Class 3 Medical Examiner:

(a) Following termination of pregnancy; Spontaneous/ induced abortion (without any sequele)

(b) Delivery by a Caesarean Section

(c) Complication following a vaginal delivery

26. For the Special Medical Examination mentioned in para 25, the licence/rating holder shall follow the following procedure: -

(a) Obtain a suitable medical appointment from any DGCA empanelled Class 3 Medical Examiner for Special Medical Examination.

(b) Apply for permission for special medical examination on format as per Appendix 'B'.

(c) Carry this permission alongwith all relevant medical documents including certificate from her treating Specialist in Obstetrics/Gynaecology, Hospital discharge summary and relevant investigation reports for Special Medical Examination.

(d) The DGCA empanelled Class 3 Medical Examiner shall forward this 'Special Medical Examination' documents to Medical Dte (DGCA) as per the procedure given at Para 20, above.

(e) Medical Assessment shall be issued by DGCA.

(f) The licence/ rating holder shall exercise the privileges of licences/ rating only on receipt of medical assessment by Medical Assessor (DGCA).

Early Renewal Medical Examination

28. The licence/rating holder can undergo an early renewal medical examination provided he/she has completed half the validity period of previous medical assessment and not within 45 days of the expiry of validity of previous medical assessment. However, the licence/rating holder has to apply for early renewal medical examinations to DGCA Medical Directorate, on the prescribed form (placed as Appendix 'B') through AMA, AAI with tenable reasons. The licence/rating holder can undergo early renewal only after the approval of his/her application by Medical Directorate, DGCA.

Licence /rating holder can undergo an early renewal medical examination provided he/she has completed half the validity period of previous medical assessment.

Lapse of Medical Assessment Validity

29. The Medical Assessment is considered 'invalid' after the validity date. In order to undergo renewal medical examination after the expiry of validity of medical assessment, the licence/rating holder has to apply to the Medical Directorate DGCA through AMA, AAI, on the prescribed format (placed as Appendix 'B') stating a tenable reason for the delay or the lapsed period. However, if the lapsed period (as calculated from the date of last medical examination) is four (04) years or more, a fresh Re- Initial Medical Examination shall be conducted.

In case the ATCO is posted to the Regional/ Corporate HQs, AAI or on foreign course etc. where Class 3 Medical requirements is not necessitated, he/she should submit the official document to that effect to DGCA along with the application.

Appeal Procedure

30. In case an ATCO is awarded a Permanent or Temporary Medical Unfitness, the procedure for appeal against the decision of Medical Directorate, DGCA is laid down in Para 7 of CAR Section 7 Series C Part I Issue II dated 12 Oct 2017 on 'Medical Requirements and Examination for Flight Crew/Air Traffic Controllers Licences and Ratings' (Revised on 05 Apr 21).

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Appendix 'A'

MEDICAL INVESTIGATIONS
(TO BE CARRIED OUT FOR ATCOs)

S.No	Occasion	Investigation to be Carried out
1.	Initial Medical Examination	(a) Blood Hb %, TLC & DLC (b) Urine RE, ME & Specific Gravity (c) ECG Resting (d) Blood Urea (e) Serum Creatinine (f) Blood Sugar (F&PP) (g) Lipid Profile (h) Liver Function Test (j) CXR (k) USG Abdomen and Pelvis (l) Ophthalmic Examination by Eye Specialist (m) Pure Tone Audiometry with ENT Splt Opinion
2.	Every Renewal Medical Examination	(a) Blood Hb %, TLC & DLC (b) Urine RE, ME & Specific Gravity (c) ECG Resting (To be opined by Medical / Aviation Medical Specialist) (d) Blood Urea (e) Serum Creatinine (f) Blood Sugar (F) upto 39 yrs of age & Blood Sugar (F,PP) after the age of 40 yrs and above (f) Ophthalmic Examination by Eye Specialist (g) Pure Tone Audiometry with ENT Splt Opinion (upto the age of 50 years)

S.No	Occasion	Investigation to be Carried out
3.	Medical Examination at 40 yrs and 50 yrs of age	(a) All investigations mentioned at S.No. 2 (b) Lipid Profile (c) Liver Function Test (d) USG Abdomen and Pelvis
4.	Once in 2 yrs after 50 yrs of age.	(a) All investigations mentioned at S.No. 2 (b) Lipid Profile (c) Liver Function Test (d) USG Abdomen and Pelvis (e) Pure Tone Audiometry

Note: -
"For Female ATCOs, Gynaecologist opinion with every Medical Examination".

Appendix 'B'

APPLICATION FOR PERMISSION FOR EARLY/DELAYED/SPECIAL /POST TEMP UNFIT/RENEWAL/RE-INITIAL MEDICAL EXAMINATION

Medical Dte,
DGCA HQ
Opposite Safdarjung Airport, Aurobindo Marg
New Delhi – 110 003

Date:

1. I, …… (Name), PMR No 1-…..…../……...-L-2 (AAI Employee Id No:…….) request permission for undergoing early/delayed/special Class-III medical examination since (state reason(s) for delay or early medical examination)……..……..……
……
……..……
……
……..……
……..……
……...……..

2. My particulars are as follows: -

(a) Email Id ……..…… (In Capital letters)

(b) Contact Number……

(c) Postal Address……..…….
……
……
(d) Date of Birth (with Age on the date of this application):……..……

(e) Details of last medical
(i) Date ……..…Valid up to: ……..
(ii) Place of Medical …….
(iii) Status Fit/ Temporary Unfit/ Permanent Unfit…….

(f) Forthcoming Medical Date……at Medical Centre/ Examiner…….
……
……..

3. I hereby declare that I have not exercised the privileges of my license when my medical was not valid.

Yours faithfully,

Enclosures:
1. Copy of Last Medical Assessment issued by DGCA.
2. Documents supporting reason for delay/ early/ special e.g. medical certificates if reason is related to medical illness

REMARKS BY MED DTE DGCA

Appendix 'C'

APPLICATION FOR SEEKING MEDICAL APPOINTMENT AT IAF BOARDING CENTRE FOR SPECIAL/ POST TEMPORARY UNFITNESS REVIEW MEDICAL EXAMINATION

Medical Dte,
DGCA HQ,
Opposite Safdarjung Airport,
Aurobindo Marg, New Delhi – 110 003

1. Name (Capital Letters Only) _____
2. PMR File No _____
3. DOB_____ Age (As on date) _____
4. AAI Employee ID _____
5. Contact No. _____
6. E-Mail ID (Capital Letters only) _____
7. Details of Last Medicals Examination (a) Medical Centre/Examiner _____
   (b) Date of Medical _____
8. Last Medical Valid up to (As per Medical Assessment_____
   issued by DGCA Medical Cell/AMA, AAI)
   Attach copy of last medical Assessment
9. Forthcoming Medical: -
   (a) Medical Type (*Tick one option*)
   a) Review after Temporary Unfit
   b) Special Medical
   (*Kindly attach necessary relevant medical documents like Cure Certificate, Hospitalization Documents, Investigations etc.)*
   (b) Intended Dates of Appointment (for IAF Boarding Centre Only)
   a) _____
   b) _____
   (c) Intended Centres (If all the options are filled, then earliest date will be allotted in either of the given options)
   a) _____
   b) _____
   c) _____

Place
Date

Signature of Individual

Remarks by AMA AAI

Remarks of Med Dte DGCA HQ Permitted Review/Special Medical Examination combined with Re-Initial/Early/Delayed at

i. Class 3 Medical Examiner
ii. Class 1 Medical Examiner
iii. IAF Boarding Centre (on _____at_____)